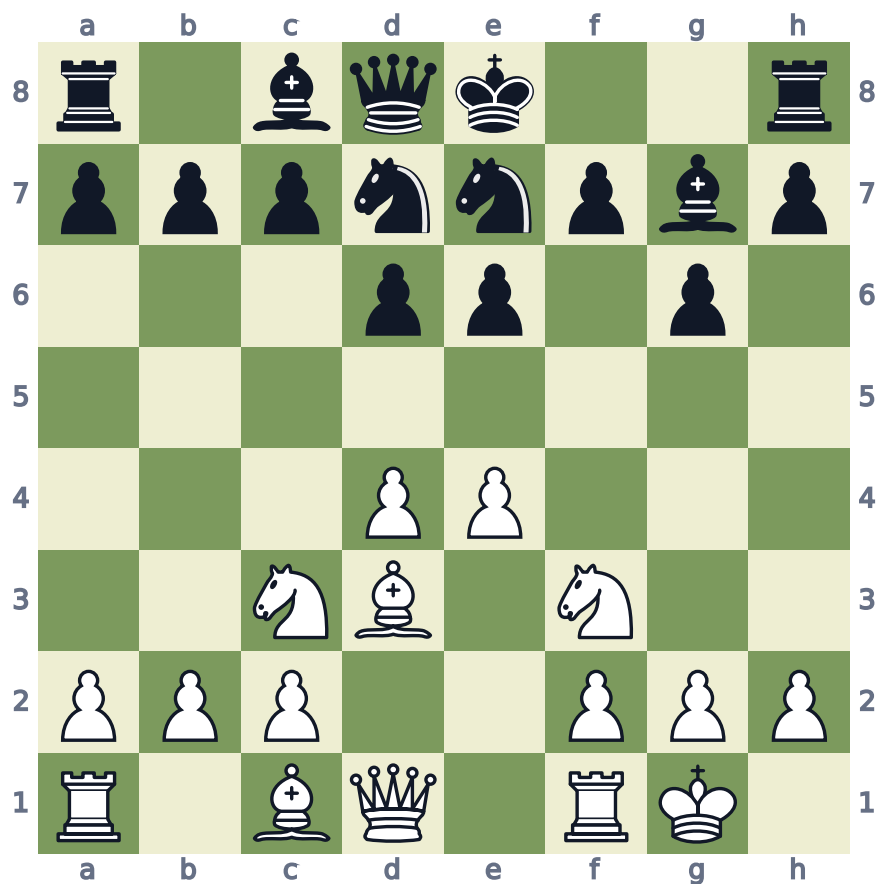


Hippo Move Orders, Transpositions, and Early Deviations

Starting with d6 or g6, delaying commitments, and answering forcing deviations



Reach the intended shell without being trapped by move-order details, early pawn storms, or center advances that make routine development unsafe.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Reach the intended shell without being trapped by move-order details, early pawn storms, or center advances that make routine development unsafe.

THE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- First identify the center, both kings, and the opponent's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram, name the urgent threat and compare e5, c5, f5, and b5.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, its purpose, and the opponent's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected Black core repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the PGN companions make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

The order of g6, d6, Bg7, and e6 should answer the opponent's immediate idea.

PRINCIPLE 2

Starting with d6 limits some early e5 advances; starting with g6 preserves more transpositions.

PRINCIPLE 3

Ne7 keeps the f-pawn free, while Nd7 supports several central reactions.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

A forcing threat outranks completion of the setup.

PRINCIPLE 5

Queen and bishop placement should be delayed until the center reveals the correct file or diagonal.

PRINCIPLE 6

Transposition skill means recognizing the same position, not memorizing another name.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|--|---|
| 01 | 1...d6 first against e4 | d6 first changes options, not the final structure. |
| 02 | 1...d6 first against d4 | Reach the shell with the order that removes the opponent's most forcing option. |
| 03 | Delay d6 until the center appears | Flexibility has value only until the opponent makes a threat. |
| 04 | Delay the kingside castle | Delayed castling is a decision, not a habit; reassess after every file opens. |
| 05 | Early f4 changes the order | When f4 appears, kingside contact outranks decorative completion. |
| 06 | Early h4 requires h6 | h6 is useful only if the saved tempo produces central play. |
| 07 | Hold the queen until the center settles | Place the queen behind the break, not behind the opening's name. |
| 08 | Meet Bh6 before routine castling | A direct bishop challenge is a concrete event; the checklist pauses here. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

1...d6 first against e4



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 e6 5. Bd3 Ne7 6. O-O Nd7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use d6 to discourage some early e5 tactics, then transpose into the shell.

MAIN DANGER

White may choose f4 before Black completes development.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

d6 first changes options, not the final structure.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.80 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bg5 a6 2. Qd2 h6 3. Be3 b6 4. Rfd1 Bb7 5. a4 Nf6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

1...d6 first against e4



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

1...d6 first against d4



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

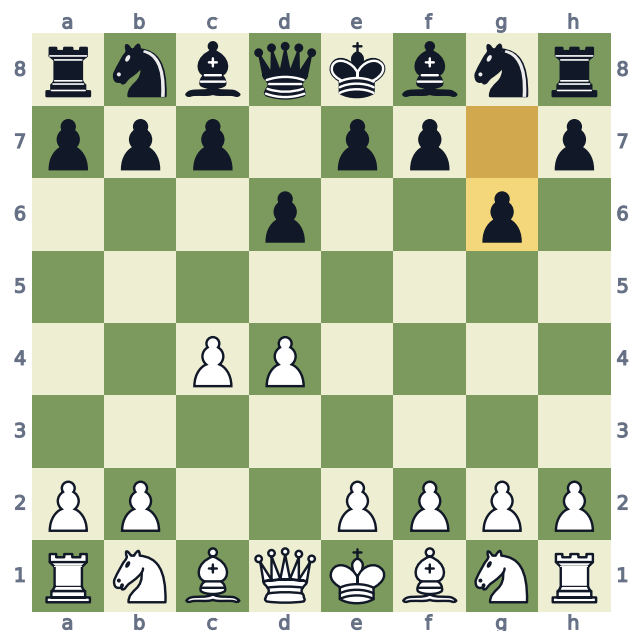
Keep the move order compact while reading White's center.

MAIN DANGER

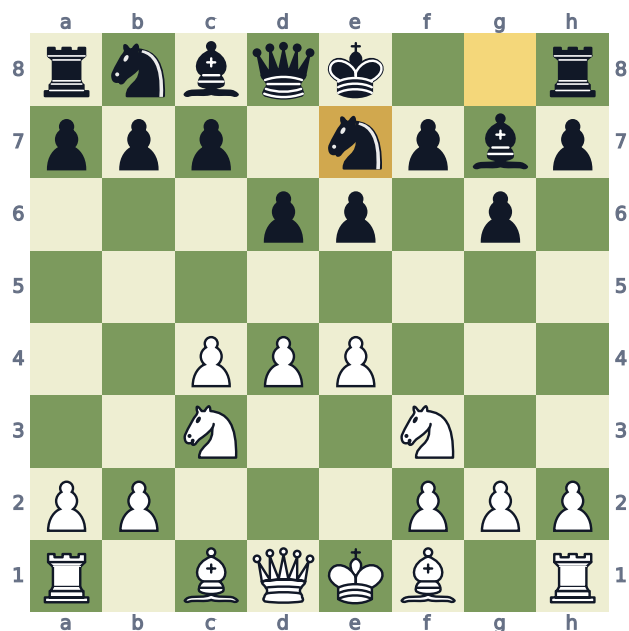
e5 or d5 can gain space before Black finishes.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Reach the shell with the order that removes the opponent's most forcing option.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.18 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be3 O-O 2. h4 e5 3. h5 exd4 4. Nxd4 Nbc6 5. Qd2 Nxd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

1...d6 first against d4



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Delay d6 until the center appears



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. Nc3 Bg7 3. d4 d6 4. Be3 e6 5. Qd2 Ne7 6. O-O-O Nd7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Preserve transpositions, then choose d6 once White shows e4-d4.

MAIN DANGER

White's h4 can force king-safety decisions immediately.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Flexibility has value only until the opponent makes a threat.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.39 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bh6 Bxh6 2. Qxh6 a6 3. Qg7 Rf8 4. Nh3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Delay d6 until the center appears



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Delay the kingside castle



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. f4 e6 5. Be3 Ne7 6. Qd2 Nd7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Complete useful development while waiting to see where White castles.

MAIN DANGER

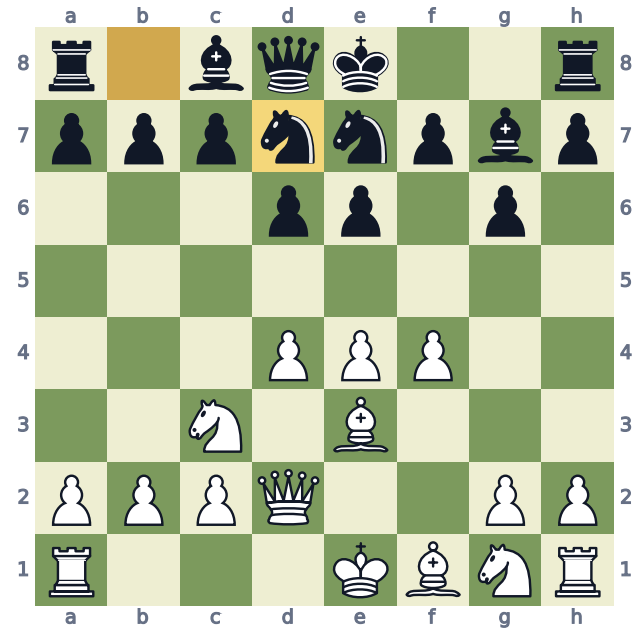
Keeping the king central too long can make e5 decisive.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Delayed castling is a decision, not a habit; reassess after every file opens.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.75 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bd3 a6 2. O-O-O b5 3. h4 Nf6 4. e5 Ng4 5. h5 Nf5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Delay the kingside castle



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Early f4 changes the order



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. e4 d6 4. Nc3 e6 5. f4 Ne7 6. Nf3 O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

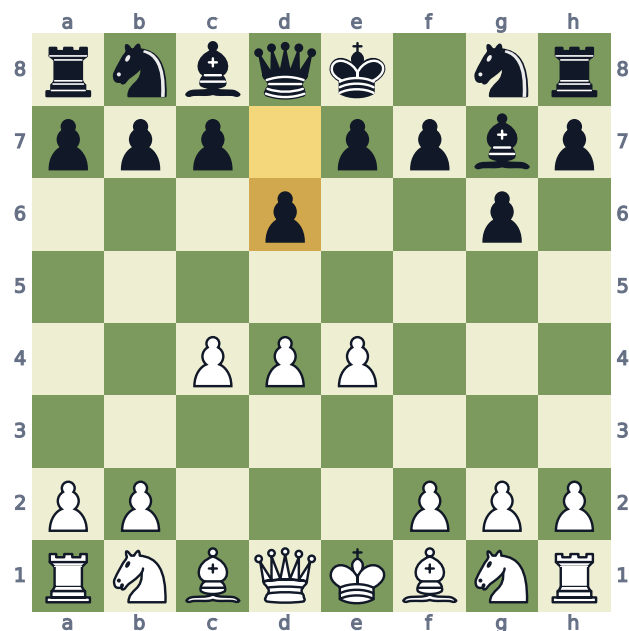
Secure the king and prepare f5 or e5 before slower queenside moves.

MAIN DANGER

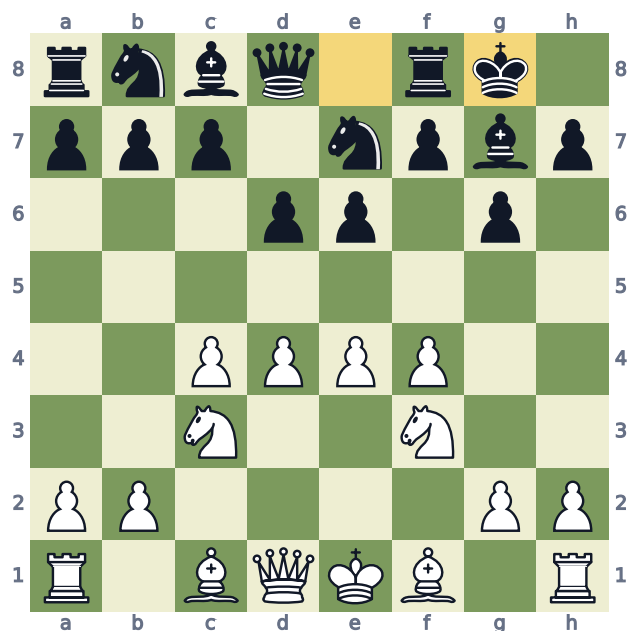
f5 may meet e5 and open a dangerous diagonal.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When f4 appears, kingside contact outranks decorative completion.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.95 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be2 Nd7 2. O-O Nf6 3. Kh1 b6 4. a4 a6 5. Be3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Early f4 changes the order



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Early h4 requires h6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. h4 h6 5. f4 e6 6. Nf3 Ne7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Buy time against h5 while building the central counterstrike.

MAIN DANGER

h5 may still sacrifice a pawn to open the file.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

h6 is useful only if the saved tempo produces central play.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.83 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. h5 gxh5 2. Bd3 a6 3. Qe2 b5 4. e5 Nf5 5. Bxf5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Early h4 requires h6



YOUR TASK

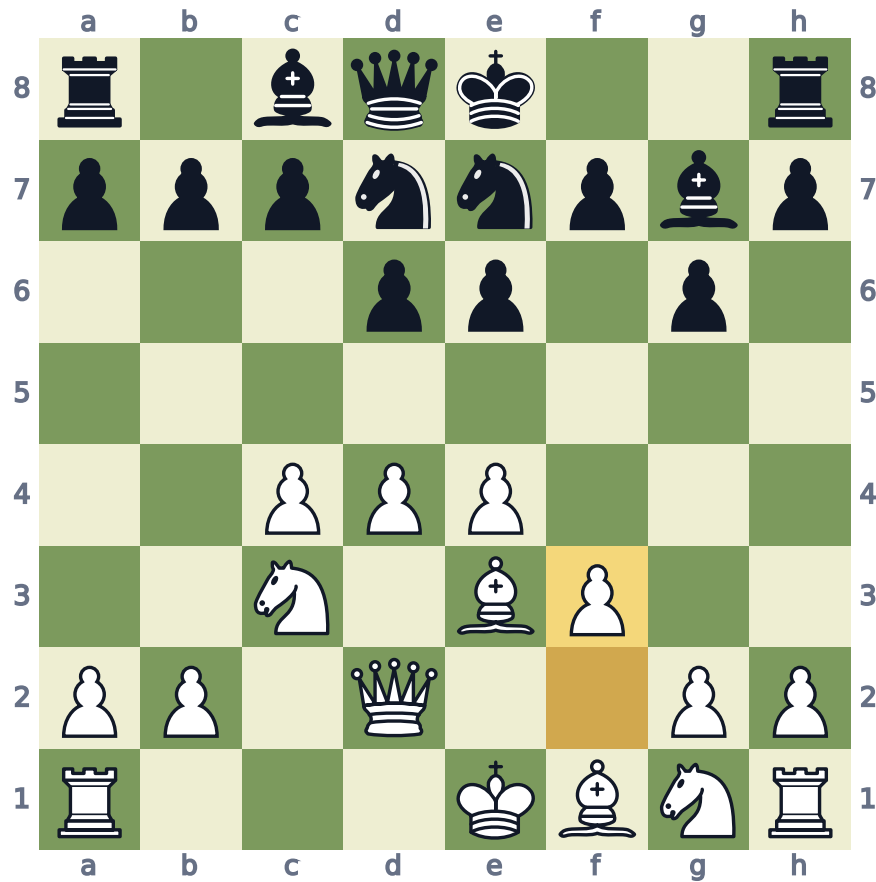
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Hold the queen until the center settles



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. Be3 Ne7 6. Qd2 Nd7 7. f3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

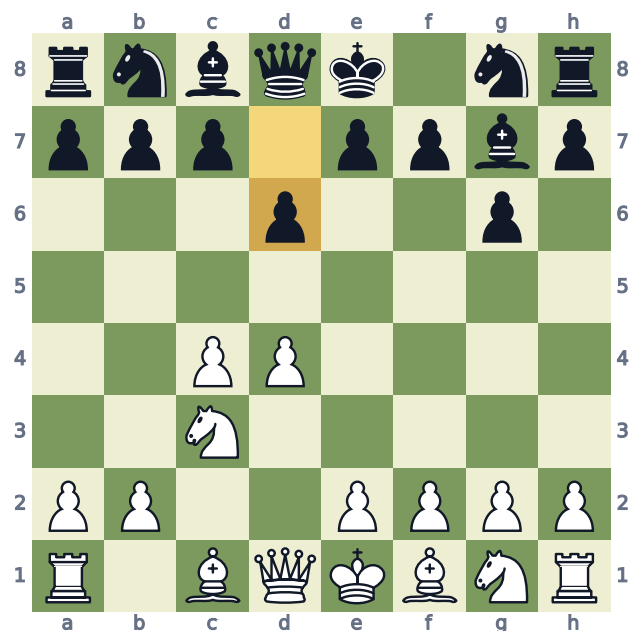
Keep Qe8, Qd7, and c7 available until the break and king location are known.

MAIN DANGER

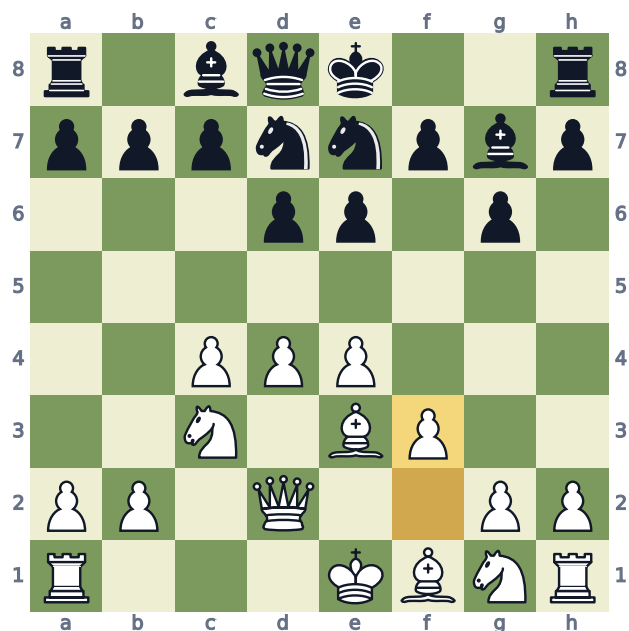
White may castle long and attack before Black chooses a plan.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Place the queen behind the break, not behind the opening's name.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.93 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. h5 O-O-O 2. a6 h4 3. b5 Nh3 4. bxc4 Bxc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Hold the queen until the center settles



YOUR TASK

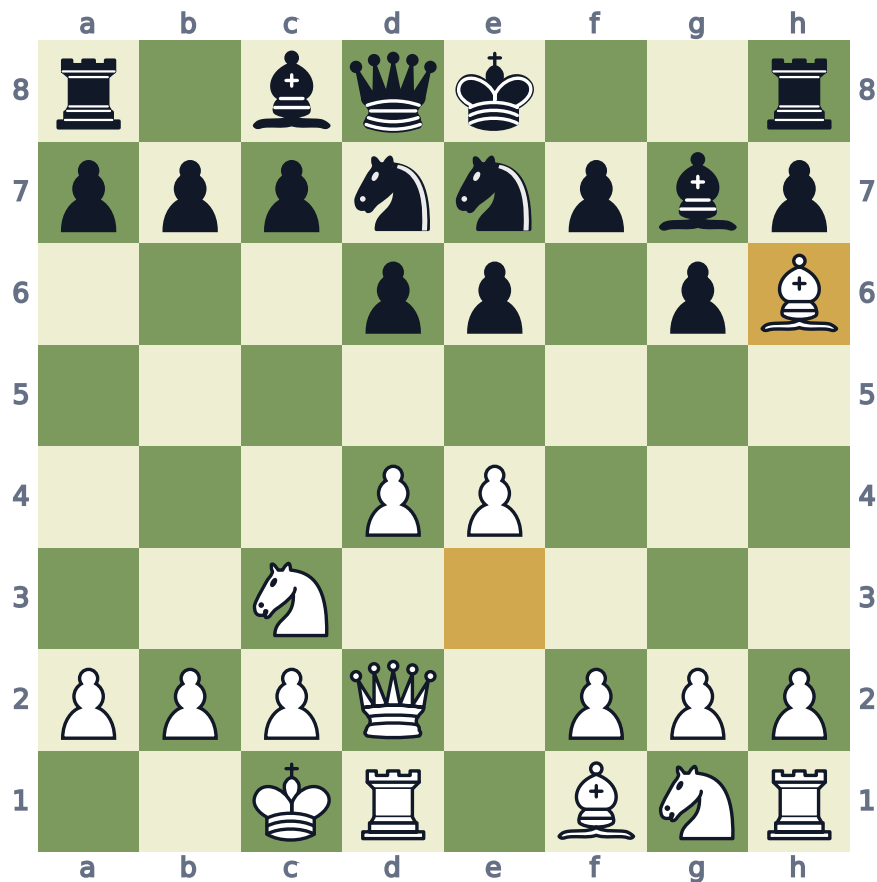
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Meet Bh6 before routine castling



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. Be3 e6 5. Qd2 Ne7 6. O-O-O Nd7 7. Bh6

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

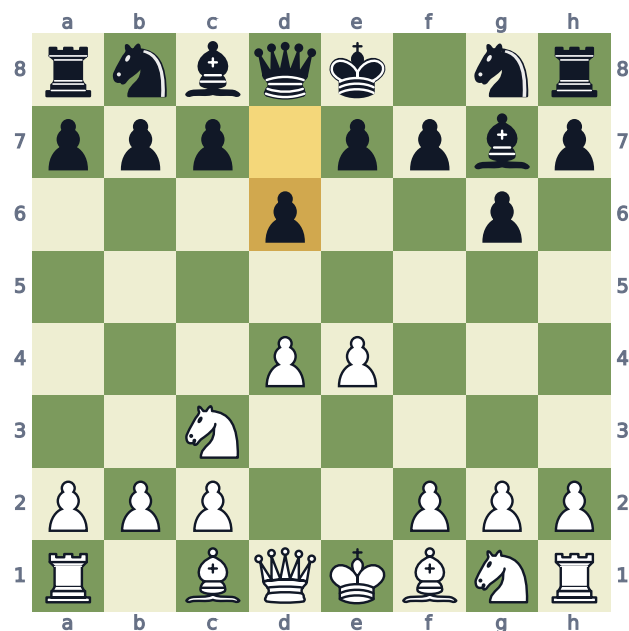
Decide whether to exchange bishops, retreat, or keep the king central before castling.

MAIN DANGER

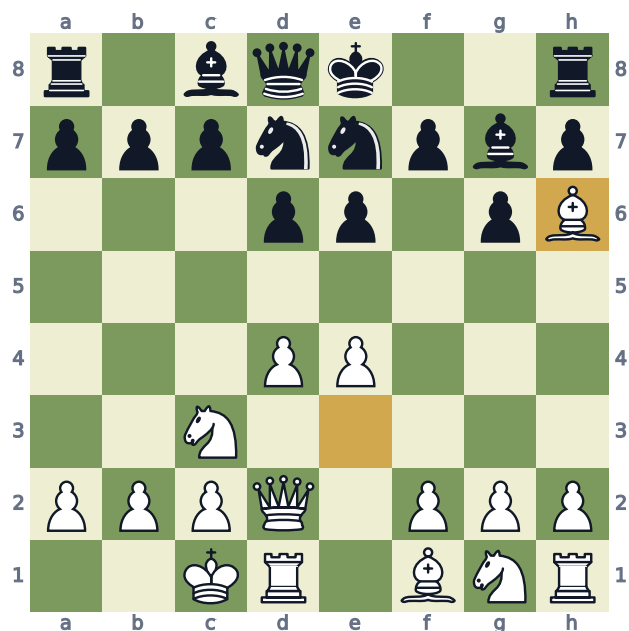
Bxh6 can remove the main dark-square defender and open h-file ideas.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A direct bishop challenge is a concrete event; the checklist pauses here.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.26 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bxh6 Qxh6 2. a6 Qg7 3. Rf8 h4 4. b5 Nf3 5. Ng8 e5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Meet Bh6 before routine castling



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. 1...D6 FIRST AGAINST E4

Course move: Bg7. Purpose: Use d6 to discourage some early e5 tactics, then transpose into the shell. Engine comparison: 1. Bg7 Be3 2. a6 Nf3 3. Nd7 a4 4. c5 dxc5 5. Nxc5 Bxc5 (+0.72 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: White may choose f4 before Black completes development.

02. 1...D6 FIRST AGAINST D4

Course move: Bg7. Purpose: Keep the move order compact while reading White's center. Engine comparison: 1. Bg7 e4 2. Nf6 Be2 3. O-O Nf3 4. e5 O-O 5. Re8 dxe5 (+0.60 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e5 or d5 can gain space before Black finishes.

03. DELAY D6 UNTIL THE CENTER APPEARS

Course move: d6. Purpose: Preserve transpositions, then choose d6 once White shows e4-d4. Engine comparison: 1. d6 Nf3 2. Nf6 Be3 3. O-O Qd2 4. c6 Bh6 5. Bg4 O-O-O (+0.67 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: White's h4 can force king-safety decisions immediately.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. DELAY THE KINGSIDE CASTLE

Course move: d6. Purpose: Complete useful development while waiting to see where White castles. Engine comparison: 1. c6 Nf3 2. d5 e5 3. Bg4 h3 (+0.68 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Keeping the king central too long can make e5 decisive.

05. EARLY F4 CHANGES THE ORDER

Course move: d6. Purpose: Secure the king and prepare f5 or e5 before slower queenside moves. Engine comparison: 1. d6 Nc3 2. Nf6 Be2 3. O-O Nf3 4. e5 O-O 5. Nc6 d5 (+0.63 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: f5 may meet e5 and open a dangerous diagonal.

06. EARLY H4 REQUIRES H6

Course move: d6. Purpose: Buy time against h5 while building the central counterstrike. Engine comparison: 1. c6 Nf3 2. d5 e5 3. Bg4 h3 (+0.68 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: h5 may still sacrifice a pawn to open the file.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. HOLD THE QUEEN UNTIL THE CENTER SETTLES

Course move: d6. Purpose: Keep Qe8, Qd7, and c7 available until the break and king location are known. Engine comparison: 1. c5 d5 2. d6 e4 3. Bxc3+ bxc3 4. e5 f4 5. f5 Nf3 (+0.63 for White (White is slightly better)).

Warning: White may castle long and attack before Black chooses a plan.

08. MEET BH6 BEFORE ROUTINE CASTLING

Course move: d6. Purpose: Decide whether to exchange bishops, retreat, or keep the king central before castling.

Engine comparison: 1. c6 Nf3 2. d5 e5 3. Bg4 h3 (+0.68 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Bxh6 can remove the main dark-square defender and open h-file ideas.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.